

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

1st August, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

31st WEEK



USA & RUSSIA

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS, INDIAN DIASPORA.



Learning Space

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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

1st AUGUST, 2017

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Dangerous escalation

Russia's expulsion of U.S. mission staff could lock the two countries into a retaliatory spiral

Russian President Vladimir Putin's decision to cut the U.S. diplomatic presence in the country by 755 signals a serious escalation in tensions between the two superpowers. His move came three days after the U.S. Senate passed a sanctions Bill targeting Moscow and allies. The scale of the cut is unprecedented and is comparable to the shutdown of the American diplomatic mission in Russia after the 1917 Bolshevik revolution. The decision also signals that Mr. Putin, who had pinned hopes on the Donald Trump administration to improve ties, is losing heart about such a reset. When Barack Obama expelled Russian diplomats in the last leg of his presidency over Moscow's alleged interference in the presidential election, Mr. Putin did not retaliate, apparently hoping to strike a new beginning with the incoming administration. During his campaign, Mr. Trump himself had expressed interest in building stronger ties with Moscow. But despite Mr. Trump's overtures, the U.S. establishment has continued to take a hard-line position towards Moscow. While the investigation into the allegations of Russia's election-time interference is still under way, Congress went ahead preparing the sanctions Bill. Passed by both Houses of Congress with a near-total majority, the Bill also seeks to limit Mr. Trump's ability to suspend or lift sanctions on Russia. After the White House said the President would sign the Bill, Moscow retaliated.

The new sanctions will add to Russia's economic troubles at a time it is already battling sanctions imposed by Europe and the U.S., and dealing with a commodities meltdown. Mr. Putin could impose counter-sanctions, but the chances of winning a trade war with the world's largest economy are slim. Hence, Russia's formal declaration of a diplomatic war to show that it can hurt America's geopolitical interests elsewhere. Whenever Russia and the U.S. joined hands to address the world's pressing problems in recent years, there were results. The Iran nuclear deal is one example. The Trump administration's willingness to work with the

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NEWS REPORT

- 1 Recently, the U.S. Senate passed a sanctions bill targeting Moscow and its allies.
- 2 Now, Russian President Vladimir Putin has decided to cut the U.S. diplomatic presence in the country by 755.
- 3 It signals a serious escalation in tensions between the two superpowers.



USA



Donald Trump
President

(USA is Federal Presidential
Constitutional Republic)



House of Representatives

(Lower House)

435 voting members and 6 non-
voting members



Senate

(Upper House)

100 seats



U.S. Congress



SITUATION DURING THE LAST DAYS OF BARACK OBAMA

- 1 Barack Obama expelled Russian diplomats in the last leg of his Presidency, that was over Moscow's alleged interference in the Presidential elections.
- 2 Mr. Putin did not retaliate then, apparently hoping to strike a new beginning with the new administration.
- 3 Mr. Trump expressed interest in building ties with Moscow.

Now, it is very clear that the U.S. establishment has continued to take a hard-line position towards Moscow.

THE U.S.A AND RUSSIA TOGETHER ... POSITIVE RESULTS



ISSUE NO: 1



The Iran nuclear deal in 2015 was made possible because of the concerted efforts by the USA and Russia was one among the P5+1 countries.

THE U.S.A AND RUSSIA TOGETHER ... POSITIVE RESULTS



ISSUE NO: 2

The willingness to work with the Russians in Syria has also helped calm returning to the parts of the war-ravaged country. The ceasefire by Moscow and Washington between the Syrian regime and rebels is still holding.

THE U.S.A AND RUSSIA TOGETHER ... FUTURE POSSIBLE SCENARIOS



ISSUE NO: 1

Addressing the North Korean nuclear crisis diplomatically by the USA requires support not only from China but also from Russia.

THE U.S.A AND RUSSIA TOGETHER ... FUTURE POSSIBLE SCENARIOS

ISSUE NO: 2



In solving the issue of instability in Afghanistan, the cooperation between the U.S and Russia is very much essential and Russia is reportedly arming the Taliban in Afghanistan.

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Instead of expanding their cooperation and addressing these challenges as responsible global leaders, the nuclear-armed powers seem to have fallen into the old Cold War-era spiral of irrational mutual hostility.

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FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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